Amr Elaouby, BSc, MBA

Director of Operations | Digital Transformation Lead | Strategy Consultant
amr@elaouby.com | +974 7070 7652 | linkedin.com/in/elaouby

▪ Professional Summary

Operations and Strategy Leader with 12+ years driving growth across F&B, hospitality, and mega-events. **Long-term Qatar resident (since 1996)** with deep local market insight and an **MBA in Crisis Management**. Proven expert in scaling multi-unit concepts, **driving lifestyle luxury operations at W Doha**, delivering high-stakes FIFA World Cup operations (QR 40M+), and managing VVIP royal hospitality. Combines an engineering background with commercial acumen to turn around distressed assets, optimize supply chains, and lead large-scale teams (up to 8,000 staff). A hands-on leader who leverages data and digital tools to maximize profitability, consistency, and customer retention.

▪ Core Competencies

Business Transformation | Digital & AI Automation | Operations Leadership | Multi-Unit Management | Business Development & Partnerships | In-House Marketing Strategy | IT-Driven Optimization | Crisis & Risk Management

▪ Professional Experience

• Catering Manager (Temporary Assignment) | W Doha Hotel & Residences | Nov 2025 – Dec 2025 | Qatar

- **Strategic Selection:** Handpicked as the **sole external manager** trusted to lead W Hotel's critical operations for the **Doha Film Festival, Formula 1 Qatar Grand Prix**, and **FIFA Arab Cup 2025**, bridging the gap between hotel standards and stadium logistics.
- **Mega-Event Execution:** Commanded premium catering for **141 VVIP Skyboxes** across Lusail and Education City Stadiums, treating each unit as a standalone banquet venue with zero margin for error.
- **VVIP & Royal Protocol:** Personally managed high-stakes hospitality for **H.E. Sheikh Jassim bin Hamad, H.E. Sheikha Al Mayassa bint Hamad**, and **H.E. Sheikha Hind bint Hamad Al Thani**. Also coordinated exclusive services for the **Jordanian Royal Family**, including **Crown Prince Al Hussein**, **Prince Hashem**, and **Princess Salma bint Abdullah II**, working directly with Amiri Diwan.
- **Workforce Scalability:** Orchestrated a massive labor surge, **quadrupling staffing levels** on event days by integrating hotel core teams with outsourced units to ensure incident-free delivery across multiple venues.

• General Manager | Second Bite Nutrition Center | Jan 2024 – Oct 2025 | Qatar

- **Turnaround Strategy:** Orchestrated the rescue and corporate spin-off of a distressed asset, transforming it from a failing department to a standalone entity. **Reduced total costs by ~40%** and improved net margin from **-30% to -5%** (near break-even) in under 12 months.
- **Culinary Operations & Menu Strategy:** Personally supervised the **R&D, testing, and costing** of a **230-dish precision menu**, moving from unscalable custom orders to standardized production. Optimized **kitchen workflows** and renegotiated **supplier contracts** to lock in fixed food costs, integrating USDA/FDA nutrition data for accuracy. This pivot to consistency surged client retention from **9% to 44%**.
- **Digital Transformation (Full-Stack Development):** Personally architected and **coded a proprietary ERP system** (Python, PHP, MySQL, JS) integrated with WhatsApp Cloud API. Automated complex **kitchen routing** and invoicing, replacing manual labor with AI logic and **reducing staff overhead by ~70%**.
- **Marketing & Growth:** Built an internal creative team, personally handling professional **food photography/production**. Exploded digital presence (**Instagram: 3k → 60k followers**) and increased conversion rates from **1% to 12%** while slashing cost-per-lead by **77%** (QR65 → QR15).
- **Corporate Structuring:** Managed end-to-end legal formation (CR, Articles of Association, Banking) and secured strategic partnerships with **Qatar Airways**, **Qatar Foundation**, **Commercial Bank of Qatar**, etc.

• Head of Technology & Business Development | Grand Central Bakery & Kitchen | Jun 2023 – Oct 2025 | Qatar

- **Business Development & Strategic Partnerships:** Spearheaded the group's expansion into **Ministry of Finance tenders (Monaqasat)**, managing the full bid cycle to secure major B2B supply contracts with **Monoprix, Lulu Group**, and government entities.
- **F&B Operations & Client Relations:** Oversaw daily operations and quality assurance across **15+ outlets** and production divisions. Managed key corporate portfolios including **Vodafone Qatar, Shell, Qatar Museums, and DHL**, ensuring strict brand consistency and high-volume delivery.
- **Catering & Institutional Growth:** Directed large-scale institutional catering and meal supply tenders for **airlines, hospitals, and 5-star hotels**. Pioneered **Qatar's first school cashless payment platform** (CBQ/SkipCash), a strategic move that secured exclusive partnerships with **Qatar International School**, **Lycée Voltaire**, etc.
- **Marketing & ROI Optimization:** Internalized all marketing functions (Meta, Google Ads), reducing external agency costs by **over 60%**. Integrated ERP and POS systems across the network to provide real-time visibility on **food costs, stock levels, and sales performance**, directly improving bottom-line profitability.

- **Venue Operations Manager | FIFA World Cup Qatar 2022 | Oct 2022 – Jan 2023 | Qatar**
  - **Rapid Promotion & Leadership:** Recruited by industry veterans and **promoted within one month** from Assistant Manager (Ahmad Bin Ali Stadium) to **Venue Manager** for **Education City Stadium**, a flagship tournament venue.
  - **Massive Scale Operations:** Commanded a workforce of **over 8,000 staff** across F&B, logistics, and finance. Oversaw the operational readiness and execution of **44 concession zones** serving tens of thousands of fans per match.
  - **Operational Excellence:** Achieved **zero major operational incidents** across all match days. Personally led daily 16-18 hour on-site inspections to ensure strict compliance with **FIFA, Supreme Committee, and WHO standards**.
  - **Stakeholder Management:** Served as the primary liaison for FIFA officials, security protocols, and supplier logistics, ensuring seamless inventory replenishment and crowd flow management under extreme pressure.
  - **Cross-Venue Support:** Recognized for high performance and deployed to support operations at **Khalifa International** and **Lusail Stadiums** for the tournament's final matches and bump-out logistics. Received direct commendations from **FIFA and Senior Management** for leadership resilience.

- **Independent Marketing & Business Consultant | Dubai Media City | Apr 2022 – Oct 2022 | UAE**
  - **Strategic Advisory (UAE Market):** Established an independent consultancy delivering **go-to-market strategies** and brand positioning for **Automotive and F&B** clients across Dubai, Sharjah, RAK, and Abu Dhabi.
  - **Operational Turnaround:** Contracted by **Red Fox Automotive** (multi-branch network) to restructure marketing operations. Directed integrated campaigns, managed external agencies, and implemented performance analytics to enforce **marketing accountability and ROI**.
  - **Business Development & Planning:** Advised business owners on **pricing models, sales strategies, and competitive positioning**, directly refining business plans for service and retail sector growth.
  - **Professional Impact:** Provided high-level due diligence and strategic assessments that established a strong professional network, resulting in a direct referral and recruitment for the **FIFA World Cup Qatar 2022** project.

- **General Manager | Crusoe – Your Car's Bodyguard | Mar 2021 – Mar 2022 | Qatar**
  - **Startup Scaling & Exit Strategy:** Successfully scaled a mobile automotive service startup from early-stage concept to **operational profitability**, culminating in a strategic **acquisition by Ali International Trading**.
  - **Operational Infrastructure:** Built the entire service ecosystem from scratch, implementing **CRM, booking, and dispatch** to manage mobile crews and optimize routes. Designed standardized SOPs for operations to ensure service consistency.
  - **Commercial Leadership:** Owned full **P&L responsibility**, managing budgeting, supplier negotiations, and pricing models. Led digital marketing and client acquisition channels to drive rapid market penetration.
  - **Team & Vendor Management:** Supervised end-to-end recruitment and training for technical teams while handling vendor sourcing and supply chain cost optimization to maximize gross margins.

- **Operations & Business Development Manager | Global Company for HoReCa Preparations | Jan 2018 – Feb 2021 | Egypt**
  - **Multi-Concept Management:** Established a hybrid hospitality complex comprising a **Specialty Café**, **Street Food Grillhouse**, and **Two Entertainment Centers**, positioning it as a premier regional social hub.
  - **F&B Innovation:** Launched the region's first **"Third-Wave" coffee concept** (V60/Chemex) and standardized recipes for a high-volume grillhouse, managing demand that frequently resulted in queues extending outside the venue.
  - **Tech Ecosystem:** Engineered a **custom POS/ERP system** integrating F&B sales with entertainment hardware (automating PlayStation/PC power cycles based on payment). Built a local **Plex media server** to stream licensed movies, bypassing data caps to minimize costs.
  - **Marketing:** Internalized all content creation and ad buying, personally managing professional photography and establishing a dominant local digital presence.

Education & Certifications

- **Master of Business Administration (MBA) – Crisis & Risk Management + Marketing Management (Double Major)**
  - Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport, Egypt, 2019
  - GPA 3.95/4.0
- **Bachelor of Science (BSc) – Petroleum Engineering**
  - Texas A&M University, Qatar Foundation, Qatar, 2014
- **Professional Certifications:**
  - **Food Handler Certificate**, Qatar, valid till Oct 2026
  - **Digital Transformation Program – Qatar Development Bank (QDB)**, Qatar, 2025
    - Process mapping, ERP/CRM selection, data governance, analytics adoption, automation roadmaps, and change management
  - **Learn & Transform Program – Qatar Development Bank (QDB)**, Qatar, 2024
    - Strategy, operating model redesign, finance discipline, and go-to-market execution for SMEs
  - **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate**, 2023
  - **Photography & Cinematography Workshops (various)**, Qatar Photography Center, 2023-2025
  - **Google Digital Marketing Certificate**, 2022